Sous Vide Tuna

Main dishes | Sous vide

Before you start

Equipment: sous-vide bath, food-safe bag, and heavy skillet. Plan ahead: refrigerate seasoned tuna 30 minutes to overnight. For the listed 1 1/2-2-inch steaks, the saved cooking chart gives 45-60 minutes; choose temperature using the guide below.

Ingredients

Matching letters and colors = one prep bowl. Charcoal = keep separate.

Bowl A - Bag oil and optional aromatics

- [ ] 2 tuna steaks, 10-12 oz each and about 1 1/2-2 inches thick
- [ ] Kosher salt and black pepper

- [ ] 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil [Bowl A]
- [ ] Thyme, dill, parsley, shallot, or citrus zest, optional [Bowl A]
- [ ] 1/2 cup sesame seeds, optional for searing
- [ ] 2 Tbsp vegetable oil for searing

Temperature guide

105°F: nearly raw, slightly firmed; good chilled

110°F: very moist and just firmed; good for searing

115°F: meaty and moist; good for searing

120°F: firm and relatively dry

130°F: canned-tuna-like texture

1. Season and bag

1. Season 2 tuna steaks, 10-12 oz each and about 1 1/2-2 inches thick, generously with kosher salt and black pepper.

2. Bag in a single layer with 2 Tbsp extra-virgin olive oil and optional thyme, dill, parsley, shallot, or citrus zest. Refrigerate at least 30 minutes and up to overnight.

2. Cook

1. Preheat the bath to your chosen temperature from the temperature guide. Use water displacement rather than a strong vacuum if possible, to avoid deforming the tuna.

2. Cook 45-60 minutes for 1-2-inch-thick steaks. If using steaks 1 inch thick or less, cook 30-45 minutes instead.

3. Sear

1. Remove tuna and blot very dry. For a seared finish, season with black pepper or coat with optional 1/2 cup sesame seeds.

2. Heat 2 Tbsp vegetable oil in a heavy skillet until lightly smoking. Sear 30-45 seconds per side, then briefly sear the edges.

Notes

Timing clarification: your personal note says 110°F for 40 minutes. The saved source chart gives 45-60 minutes for the listed thicker steaks; the 40-minute note is preserved below as your preference.

Personal note from Recipe Index: cook at 110°F for 40 minutes, sear; maybe 105°F for rarer tuna.

The source specifically recommends 110°F for very moist seared tuna and 105°F for a nearly raw, sashimi-like texture.